While using two lanes for queuing is possible and may reduce the physical length of the queue, it does come with additional risks related to driver behaviour and capability. Lane utilisation may not be evenly distributed, as drivers often favour one lane over another, especially when approaching a merge point. Many drivers tend to merge earlier than necessary, which can cause the end of the queue to extend further back, and lead to increased end of queue risk. Driver aggression and frustration may also be experienced by those in the queue due to motorists cutting in late, which may not be the best frame of mind for drivers to be in when approaching the traffic control station or passing the workers on the site.

On multi-lane approaches, drivers are generally less prepared to stop, as they are not expecting this, which can create safety issues. The preference is to utilise queuing in a single lane where possible to minimise these risks.

If using two lanes for queuing, it's crucial to carefully assess the specific site conditions, implement additional safety measures, and closely monitor the actual queue formation during operation to ensure adequate warning of the traffic queue ahead is provided.

When multiple lanes are available within the expected queue distance, the queue length in any full width traffic lane may be used for queueing (the length of the merge taper for the merging lane must not be included in the queue length calculation). Additional queue length may be added to mitigate the risks of drivers favouring one lane over the other for queueing.

When using two lanes for queueing, consider the use of the WHEN QUEUEING USE BOTH LANES panel (TM2-Q04) and/or the MERGE IN TURN [panel (TM2-Q05) with the lane status signs.

Figure 4.8(c) – Multi message sign assembly examples for multiple lane queueing (sign located on left side of the road)